

DAY 04 OF 05

CORE + MOVEMENT QUALITY

The stability that makes your first step matter.

04

Core strength for basketball isn't about crunches — it's about anti-rotation, anti-extension, and staying stiff when the game tries to destabilize you. These three moves build the kind of core that transfers.

TODAY'S PROTOCOL

01 DEAD BUG

3 × 8 EACH SIDE

Back flat on the floor, arms straight up, knees at 90°. Slowly extend opposite arm and leg toward the floor. Do NOT let your lower back arch. The whole point is keeping the spine neutral under load.

02 PALLOF PRESS

3 × 10 EACH SIDE

Use a band anchored at chest height, or a cable machine. Press straight out from your chest and hold 2 seconds. Anti-rotation — this is the core work that transfers to cuts, not crunches.

03 90/90 TO TALL KNEELING

2 × 5 EACH SIDE

Sit in 90/90 hip position, then rise to tall kneeling without using your hands. This move connects hip mobility (Day 1) to core stability — exactly what's required when you plant and cut.

NOTE If Dead Bug feels easy, you're probably cheating. Keep your lower back glued to the floor. The second your back arches, the rep is done.